

35

PARTNER
UNIVERSITIES

42

TRADE
CONSULATES

90

INNOVATION
PARTNERS

3,000

START-UPS THAT ENGAGE
WITH THE T-HUB ECOSYSTEM

to inspire young minds. T-Hub CEO Srinivas Rao Mahankali, fondly called MSR, says the structure was designed to shatter the stereotype of dull government buildings, by making it swanky, with an aura that exudes new-age appeal.

Built on part of the 18-acre plot of land in Hyderabad's HITEC City, T-Hub can accommodate 800-1,000 start-ups and 2,800 seats at full capacity. Currently, it engages with over 500 start-ups, of which 341 operate from the facility, occupying 1,157 seats. The ground floor houses two banks—ICICI Bank and HDFC Bank—that offer banking services and collateral-free loans exclusively to T-Hub members. The first and second floors have a number of experience centres (such as Apple's) and Centres of Excellence (CoEs) from firms such as Apollo Tyres, Hexagon, NPCI, etc. But a flashy facade void of impact renders the structure irrelevant. MSR says T-Hub delivers on the foundational principle—of crafting an unrivalled start-up ecosystem—by empowering and synergising innovation across start-ups, corporates, academia, and the government.

The Telangana government has already invested ₹400 crore, while MSR indicates that the remaining portion needs another ₹40 crore to finish. Set up as a non-profit, T-Hub already has enough cash flow to run its operations, with nearly 40 per cent of its revenues coming from the co-working rental business, and corporate programmes bring in an-

IMPACT PLAYER



T-HUB'S CORE FUNCTION IS TO RUN INNOVATION PROGRAMMES IN TELANGANA FOR START-UPS, CORPORATES, ACADEMIA AND GOVERNMENT



T-HUB RUNS INCUBATION AND ACCELERATION PROGRAMMES FOR KEY GOVERNMENT DEPARTMENTS



IT HAS WORKED WITH OVER 200 FOREIGN START-UPS WHILE RUNNING THE INCUBATORS OF OTHER COUNTRIES



T-HUB HAS IMPACTED 17,000 STUDENTS FROM 35 COLLEGES IN THREE STATES THROUGH ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENTS

other 40 per cent. Start-up incubation programmes account for about 14-15 per cent, while the rest comes from its funding desk.

To be sure, T-Hub is part of the larger innovation network in Telangana that includes WE Hub—dedicated to women entrepreneurs; T-Works—for rapid prototyping of hardware products; Telangana State Innovation Cell (TSIC) and Research and Innovation Circle of Hyderabad (RICH), among others.

These entities are non-profits, with independent boards, separate managements and reporting structures. And they are all self-sufficient. "Hyderabad is known as the city of pearls. With a view to building a new-age state, the government has created a set of entities like a string of pearls that are focussed on innovation and entrepreneurship. T-Hub is the crown jewel in that piece," says MSR.

As of now, six of the 10 floors in the nearly 600,000 sq. ft building are operational, while the heart of T-Hub 2.0's operations is on the third floor where various teams, including the leadership, sit. It also houses the offices of partners such as RICH and TSIC. The fourth floor is dedicated to co-working, while the fifth floor is designed for events with a 400-seat auditorium. The sixth floor houses various incubators, including a 500-seat AI incubator run by the central government's Department of Science and Technology. The remaining floors are likely to be operational by 2023-end.